

Page 05 — About /about.html

Audited: 7 September 2026 · main 32fcad7
Method: headless Chromium at 1440 / 820 / 390 with real webfonts · geometry, image-sizing and computed-style extraction · WCAG contrast from measured pairs
Status: Audit only — no code changes applied.

5	0	3	2
CHANGES PROPOSED	HIGH	MEDIUM	LOW

68 **UX score, out of 100.** The H1 rewrite and the photograph both landed, and this is now a page that answers "who is this?" in the first screen. It loses points for burying the one piece of hard evidence it has, and for a section label that fails contrast.



1440×900. The H1 is now a sentence and the photograph is properly sized at 280×373 from a 900×1200 source. "What I've built" — the shipped iOS app — sits below the fold.

A. Hierarchy

U20 The strongest evidence on the page is styled as a footnote

MEDIUM

MEASURED

```
H1 "I'm Blake Cody – writing my way through it in public" 54.4px ✓
    about copy 16px ✓
H2 "WHAT I'VE BUILT" 13.12px --accent-soft, contrast 3.38
H3 "My JRNL" app icon 76×76, App Store badge 156×52
```

You shipped an iOS app. It is live, it is real, and it is the one thing on this page that is not a statement of intent. Its section heading is set at **13.12px** — the smallest type on the page — in a colour that fails contrast, below the fold, styled identically to a label.

An H2 at 13.12px is a section label wearing a heading's tag. That is fine for "Latest articles" on a busy homepage; it is the wrong treatment for the single strongest credibility signal on your About page.

FIX

- Set "What I've built" at the same weight as the other H2s on the site — roughly 32px Fraunces — with `--ink`, not `--accent-soft`. It becomes a section, not a caption.
- Better still, move it above the subscribe block and consider surfacing the app in the opening copy. The SEO report's **C35** made the same argument about word order; this is the visual half of it.
- The app icon renders at 76×76. Give it room — 120px or more — so it reads as a product rather than a favicon.

U21 The photograph is well handled, and it is the only one

MEDIUM

MEASURED

```
cover.jpg natural 900×1200 (0.75) displayed 280×373 (0.75)
object-fit: cover · width/height present · alt: "Blake Cody at
the 2025 U.S. Open"
```

Ratio preserved, no crop distortion, real alt text, explicit dimensions. This is the best-handled image on the site and it is exactly the fix **V4** keeps asking for elsewhere — a source and a slot that agree.

The finding is scale, not handling. At 280px wide inside a 720px column, on a 1440px screen, the one photograph of the person the page is about occupies about 4% of the viewport. On a page whose job is "decide whether you trust me", the face is small.

FIX

With **V1**'s wider column, run the photo and the opening two paragraphs as a two-column block above the fold, photo at 380–420px. On mobile it already stacks correctly, so only the desktop rule changes.

U22 Contrast: two failures, both `--accent-soft` MEDIUM → V2

Element	Colour	Size	Ratio	Needs
<code>.section-label</code> — "WHAT I'VE BUILT"	<code>#c46a4f</code>	13.1px	3.38	4.5
<code>.eyebrow</code> — "← HOME"	<code>#c46a4f</code>	13.1px	3.38	4.5

Everything else on the page passes: body copy 5.52, H1 13.62, subscribe H2 14.73, the eyebrow's own link 6.17.

One token — `--accent-soft` used for text — accounts for every contrast failure across `articles`, `book`, `reflect`, `about` and `404`. Change it to `#a8532f` (≈ 4.6) or swap those uses to `--accent` `#9a3b27` (6.17) and the entire site passes AA on text.

U23 Two subscribe asks, 200px apart LOW

MEASURED

```
.substack-btn "Read & subscribe on Substack ↗" 291x49 y ≈ 1,760
.sub-form "Subscribe →" 460 wide y = 1,966
```

Two calls to action for the same outcome — get my writing by email — within one screen of each other, in different visual languages: a solid accent button linking out to Substack, then a native email field and button posting to Substack.

A reader who has just decided to subscribe now has to work out whether these are the same thing. They are.

FIX

Keep the native form — it is the better experience and it is the one you can measure. Change the button above it to something that is not a duplicate: "Read the essays" pointing at the archive, or drop it entirely and let the copy's existing Substack link carry it.

U24 Keep KEEP

- **The H1.** "I'm Blake Cody — writing my way through it in public" at 54.4px. First person, specific, and it does the job the word "About" could not.
- **Image handling throughout** — photo, app icon and App Store badge all carry explicit dimensions and real alt text.
- **2.43 folds on desktop.** Short, and it does not pad.
- **Heading tree** H1 → H2 → H3 → H2, no skips.
- **The copy voice.** Unchanged and still right for the page.

Evidence log

Check	Result
-------	--------

Page depth	1440 → 2,189px (2.43 folds) · 820 → 2,178px (1.85) · 390 → 2,719px (3.22)
Images	logo 30×30 (60×60 src) · <code>cover.jpg</code> 280×373 from 900×1200, ratio preserved ✓ · app icon 76×76 from 192 · badge 156×52 — all with <code>width / height</code>
Headings	H1 54.4px → H2 13.12px → H3 → H2 32px — the first H2 is label-sized
Contrast	<code>.section-label</code> 3.38 fail · <code>.eyebrow</code> 3.38 fail · body 5.52 ✓ · H1 13.62 ✓
Buttons	<code>.substack-btn</code> 291×49 ✓ · <code>.sub-submit</code> 136×46 ✓
Mobile nav	clientW 170 · scrollW 385 · 3 items off-screen (R1)
Content column / focus	<code>.wrap</code> 720px (V1) · browser-default focus ring (R3)

UI page 05 of 7 complete.

blakecody.com UI change log · generated 7 September 2026